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UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

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DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP
COLLEGES OF EDUCATION
END OF SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS FOR LEVEL 300, 2023/2024
B.ED. PROGRAMME

COURSE CODE: TEEG 304
COURSE TITLE: INQUIRY AND ACTION RESEARCH FOR EARLY GRADE

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.
Time: 2 hours

SECTION A
[25 Marks]
Answer all the questions in this section.

1. What is the primary purpose of action research in education? To…
   a) compare different schools based on student outcomes.
   b) develop new theories for teaching and learning.
   c) evaluate teacher performance.
   d) improve teaching practices and student outcomes.

2. Which of the following best describes action research?
   a) A comparison of different teaching methods across multiple schools
   b) A cyclical process of planning, acting, observing, and reflecting
   c) A longitudinal study aimed at understanding an issue over several years
   d) A quantitative study of large populations for generalization

3. Which type of action research involves a teacher investigating their own practice?
   a) Collaborative action research
   b) District-level action research
   c) Individual action research
   d) School-wide action research

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4. Action research is considered a form of "disciplined inquiry" because it...
   a) follows a strict experimental design for specific purpose.
   b) follows a systematic process of investigation and reflection.
   c) is always conducted by academic researchers.
   d) uses only quantitative data to generate multiple responses.

5. How does action research bridge the gap between research and practice? By...
   a) applying research findings directly to classroom practice.
   b) conducting research in laboratory settings.
   c) focusing on theoretical frameworks.
   d) publishing results in academic journals for wider readership.

6. Which of the following is NOT a key principle of action research?
   a) Collaboration
   b) Control trials
   c) Cyclical process
   d) Reflection

7. What is the main difference between traditional research and action research?
   a) Action research is always qualitative and demanding in nature
   b) Action research aims to solve practical problems in a specific context
   c) Action research doesn't require data collection to draw a conclusion
   d) Traditional research is always conducted by teachers

8. In the context of action research, what does "reflective practice" refer to?
   a) Asking students for feedback at the end of each lesson taught
   b) Critically examining one's teaching practices and their effects
   c) Using mirrors in the classroom to reflect learners' opinions
   d) Writing daily personal diaries in one's reflective practice journal

9. Which of the following is a primary need for conducting action research in education? To...
   a) address specific issues in the classroom or school
   b) increase teacher salaries in line with global trends
   c) improve student test scores only in specific subject areas
   d) reduce classroom size to make teaching and learning effective

10. What is the first step in the action research process?
   a) Collecting data on a particular issue of interest
   b) Identifying a problem or area for improvement
   c) Implementing a solution based on one's experiences
   d) Writing the final report of action research

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11. How does action research in an inclusive classroom differ from that in a regular classroom? It...
   a) always requires external researchers.
   b) doesn't differ; the process is exactly the same in both contexts.
   c) focuses more on individual student needs and differentiation.
   d) only uses qualitative data to make generalizations about an issue.

12. What is a key consideration when conducting action research in a multi-grade classroom?
   a) Adapting research methods to address diverse age groups and learning levels
   b) Focusing only on the highest grade level and age groups in a school setting
   c) Separating students by grade and age level during the research process
   d) Using the same interventions for all grade and age levels being taught

13. Which of the following is NOT typically a step in the action research process?
   a) Acting as a researcher in all schools
   b) Generalizing results to all schools
   c) Observing learners in all schools
   d) Planning to cover all schools

14. What type of data is most commonly used in action research?
   a) Both quantitative and qualitative data
   b) Neither quantitative nor qualitative data
   c) Only qualitative data
   d) Only quantitative data

15. Which of the following is an appropriate data collection method for action research?
   a) Classroom observations
   b) Student surveys
   c) Student-led discussions
   d) Teacher reflective journals

16. When conducting action research, triangulation refers to...
   a) Analyzing data after three months of collection to increase validity.
   b) Collecting data from three different schools to increase validity.
   c) Using multiple data sources or methods to increase validity.
   d) Using only three participants in the study to increase validity.

17. What is the purpose of analyzing data in action research?
   a) To prove a hypothesis correct
   b) To identify patterns and inform future actions
   c) To compare results with other schools in a district
   d) To evaluate teacher performance in a district

18. Which of the following is NOT a common method of data analysis in action research?
a) Content analysis
b) Complex inferential statistics
c) Descriptive statistics
d) Thematic analysis

19. In action research, member checking is used to...
a) check researcher credentials and credibility.
b) compare results with other studies in a district.
c) ensure data accuracy and interpretation.
d) verify participant attendance during interviewing.

20. What is the primary purpose of writing an action research report?
a) To critique other teachers' practices
b) To fulfill college requirements for graduation
c) To get published in an academic journal
d) To share findings and reflect on the process

21. Which section of an action research report typically comes first?
a) Data analysis
b) Introduction
c) Literature review
d) Methodology

22. In an action research report, where would you typically find the researcher's reflections on the process? In the ...
a) abstract.
b) discussion or conclusion.
c) introduction.
d) methodology section.

23. What should be included in the methodology section of an action research report?
a) Both data collection and analysis procedures
b) Only data collection methods
c) Only data analysis procedures
d) Review of related literature

24. How does the discussion section of an action research report differ from that of traditional research?
a) It does not include any data interpretation section
b) It focuses more on personal reflections and implications for practice
c) It only discusses limitations of the study and not implications for practice
d) It presents new hypotheses for future research

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25. Which of the following is NOT typically included in the conclusion of an action research report?

a) Detailed statistical analyses
b) Implications for practice
c) Reflections on the research process
d) Summary of key findings

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SECTION B
(75marks)
Answer any three questions in this section.

Question 1

a) Define the term "research problem". **(6 marks)**

b) Write three action research problems which are researchable. **(9 marks)**

c) Briefly explain the following processes in conducting action research.

i. Background to the study **(2 marks)**
ii. Statement of the problem **(2 marks)**
iii. Purpose of the study **(2 marks)**
iv. Research questions **(2 marks)**
v. Significance of the study **(2 marks)**

Question 2

a) Explain Data collection in action research. **(5 Marks)**

b) Distinguish between primary and secondary data collection. **(5 Marks)**

c) Discuss three (3) importance of Data Collection in action research. **(10 Marks)**

Question 3

Explain any five (5) methods of gathering data for qualitative research. **(25 Marks)**

Question 4

As an action researcher, discuss any five (5) reasons why you must undertake literature review. **(25 marks)**

Question 5

Explain each of the following in relation to action research. **(25 marks)**

i. Action Research as a Disciplined Inquiry
ii. Action Research as a Reflective Practice
iii. Action Research as Bridging the Gap Between Research and Practice
iv. Participatory Action research
v. Practical Action Research